

PLACEHOLDER

ONWOOD TILES · BATCH ONE

Kiln

A magazine about tiles, and the coastal homes they belong in.

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FULL - BLEED IMAGE

The white tile that went *everywhere*

In 1904, two architects had to convince New Yorkers that walking into a hole in the ground was not a death sentence.

The subway did not need a tunnel. It needed ordinary people to walk down into the dark, something almost none of them had ever done. So the architects designed a room, lined at eye level in small white glazed tiles.

A glossy glaze is close to the most reflective surface money can buy, and in a station with

no windows it did the work of lamps nobody could afford. A glazed surface absorbs nothing, so tile was not a finish. It was public health equipment.

A fired glaze is a thin layer of glass. It does not fade or wear, and some of the original 1904 tile is still on the wall today.

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When timber look stopped looking *fake*

If you looked at timber look tile in 2004 and have not since, your opinion is correct and out of date. Back then you could stand at the door and see the repeat.

The reason was the printing. Screens press one image onto the tile, so a typical run had just four faces. Four faces across forty square metres is a repeat every few tiles.

Then, around 2007, printheads arrived that recirculate the ink so the pigment cannot settle. Printing went digital, and faces were free. A maker could scan a real board and print every plank.

It got better because a printhead stopped clogging.

Porcelain or ceramic, in one number

The distinction is not marketing. It is a number you can measure.

The definition is water absorption. Porcelain absorbs half a percent of its weight or less. Fire a fine clay hot enough and the mineral fuses into glass that closes the pores, so a vitrified body does not drink. Everything above that line is ceramic, lighter and cheaper and perfectly good on a wall.

A vitrified body is essentially a manufactured stone. It does not drink.

THANKS FOR READING

**Come and
see it full *size***

*Everything in these pages is on a board in the Baringa
showroom, in real light.*